assimilation.[14] The Jewish State would appear for many Jews to be the guarantor of Jewish survival. But for some, any attachment to the State of Israel looks like sectarianism, a return to the ghetto. They feel they are required to be universalist and avoid any "separateness." They probably ignore the Jewish tradition of solidarity which is the oldest and most impressive in modern history. Those who succeeded economically and politically in the past often mobilized to help their disadvantaged coreligionists throughout the world.

Despite finding themselves divided into diverse nationalities and identities in the wake of Emancipation, Jews maintained their involvement with each other. Significantly, in the wake of the 1840 Damascus blood libel, a group of European Jewish notables did not hesitate to cross land and sea to aid Syrian Jews in distress.[15] The Alliance Israélite Universelle, the first international humanitarian organization, was set up in Paris in 1860 by French Jews to help Jews in countries where they suffered from poverty and oppression.[16] Since then, with increasing antisemitism and the persecution of Jews, it became even more necessary to establish powerful organizations to foster Jewish solidarity and lobby for Jewish causes. Yet we must remember that before the establishment of the State of Israel, the Jews had only their own organizations and their philanthropists to help them in time of need. We know today that even the greatest philanthropists and organizations are insufficient to prevent persecution and disaster for Jews. The Holocaust is the most tragic evidence of the limitations of Jewish organizations. And Jewish solidarity will often be interpreted by antisemites as a secret project for world domination—a Jewish plot.

A recent horrifying example of the misinterpretation of "Jewish solidarity" occurred in France in France in 2006. A young French Jew, Ilan Halimi, was kidnapped and tortured over the course of twenty-four days. He was found, naked and handcuffed, and died of his wounds on the way to a hospital. The "Gang of the Barbarians," assisted by several "unscrupulous" women who lured him into their trap, assumed that "the Jewish community," "rich" and "united," would pay a ransom.[17]

Besides the classic irrational antisemitism, we perceive here again the fantasy of the Jews as "masters of the world," wealthy and united in helping each other. Jewish solidarity, linked to Jewish suffering, can also be linked to the phantasm of Jewish power or domination. In the particular case of Ilan Halimi's murder, we can observe that unfortunately, antisemitism in its most cruel form, can appear among women just as well as among men.

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